HISTORICAL ARCHIVAL REPORT · V1.0
REF: ESN-FON-2026-001
CENTRE-FORWARD AUDIT · MARRAKECH / NICE / REIMS · 1950–1962
PRIMARY SOURCE: GUERIN SPORTIVO (BIO)

JUST FONTAINE



Centre-forward (Prima punta) · US Marocaine · OGC Nice · Stade de Reims · 1950–1962
France · **Born 18 August 1933, Marrakech (Morocco)**
Nickname: *Justo* PER SOURCE
1958 World Cup top scorer — 13 goals in 6 matches FIFA
European Cup top scorer 1958-59 — 10 goals UEFA
4x French Champion · 2x Coupe de France GUERIN SPORTIVO
Tier 3: BLOCKED · Retrospective feature only · **FGA NOT ISSUED**

⚠ HISTORICAL ARCHIVE · TIER 3 BLOCKED

Read this first — Tier 3 is BLOCKED, not partial. Just Fontaine played from 1950 to 1962. **No full 90-minute footage is held in this file**, and **no match-by-match event log, no line-ups, and no video-derived scoring have been performed**. The only source is a single retrospective magazine feature (*Guerin Sportivo* biography) plus historical records. **The percentages and charts on this page are inferential analyst estimates only — not Tier 3 validated, not video-scored, not FGA output. No FGA rating can be issued.**

ERA	1958 WORLD CUP	TIER 3	FGA RATING
1950–1962	13 Goals	BLOCKED	N/A
Nice 1953–56 · Reims 1956–62	Top scorer · 3rd place	0 / 12 · no event log	Withheld by rule · no proxy

1 · SUBJECT PROFILE

FICHE DE JOUEUR · PLAYER CARD

HISTORICAL ARCHIVE — REIMS ERA SNAPSHOT

NOME / NAME	**Just Louis Fontaine**
NASCITA / BORN	**18 August 1933 · Marrakech, Morocco**
RUOLO / POSITION	**Centre-forward (Attaccante / Prima punta)**
ALTEZZA / HEIGHT	**1.74 m (5 ft 8 in)** GUERIN SPORTIVO
PESO / WEIGHT	**72 kg (159 lbs)** GUERIN SPORTIVO
STATO ATTUALE / CURRENT STATUS	**Deceased — 1 March 2023 (aged 89)**

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Full name	Just Louis Fontaine (born Justo Ortega)
Nickname	*Justo* — the family name, gallicised to Just GUERIN SPORTIVO
Position	**Centre-forward** — a complete striker: rapid dribbling, precise touches, lethal shot with either foot, anticipation a split-second ahead of defenders GUERIN SPORTIVO
Height / Weight	1.74 m · 72 kg GUERIN SPORTIVO
Club History	**1950–1953:** US Marocaine **1953–1956:** OGC Nice **1956–1962:** Stade de Reims
Career Totals (League)	**48 matches · 62 goals** (US Marocaine) · **69 matches · 42 goals** (Nice) · **131 matches · 122 goals** (Reims) GUERIN SPORTIVO TABLE
League	Moroccan League · French Division 1
Career span	1950–1962 (12 seasons)
Born	**18 August 1933, Marrakech, Morocco** GUERIN SPORTIVO
National team	**France: 21 caps, 30 goals** · 1958 World Cup GUERIN SPORTIVO
Honours (Club)	**OGC Nice:** Coupe de France 1953-54 · French Champion 1955-56 GUERIN SPORTIVO **Stade de Reims:** French Champion 1957-58, 1959-60, 1961-62 · Coupe de France 1957-58 GUERIN SPORTIVO
Honours (Individual)	**1958 World Cup Golden Boot** — 13 goals FIFA **European Cup Top Scorer 1958-59** — 10 goals UEFA **French Division 1 Top Scorer** — 1958, 1960 GUERIN SPORTIVO
Tier 3 evidence	✖ BLOCKED — RETROSPECTIVE FEATURE ONLY, NO EVENT LOG, NO VIDEO LOG

2 · CAREER TRAJECTORY

PERIOD	CLUB / TEAM	LEAGUE	ROLE	KEY CONTEXT
1950–1953	US Marocaine	Moroccan League	Forward	Formative years · won Coupe du Nord-Afrique 1952 · 62 league goals GUERIN SPORTIVO
1953–1956	OGC Nice	French Division 1	Inside forward / Centre-forward	Discovered by Mario Zatelli · 42 league goals · Coupe de France 1954 · Champion 1956 · conflicts with Luis Carniglia GUERIN SPORTIVO
1956–1962	Stade de Reims	French Division 1	Centre-forward	Most expensive French player at the time · 122 league goals · 4 titles · 1959 European Cup finalist GUERIN SPORTIVO
1958	France	World Cup	Centre-forward	13 goals in 6 matches · Golden Boot · 3rd place FIFA

3 · THE 1958 WORLD CUP & SOURCE QUOTES

> **Source:** *Guerin Sportivo* (biography feature). A retrospective Italian magazine piece with photographs, narrative prose, and direct quotes from Fontaine — **not a contemporaneous match report**.

3.1 · THE 1958 EXPLOIT — 13 GOALS

> *"Ero in gran spolvero nei giorni di Svezia, perché mi ero preso la… pausa invernale, dal 7 dicembre al 15 febbraio ero stato fuori per un intervento al menisco, così trovai la forma giusta in tempo."*
>
> — Just Fontaine, Guerin Sportivo

The defining achievement of his career. Fontaine was called up as a reserve for the 1958 World Cup, but an injury to first-choice striker René Bliard gave him the starting spot. He scored in **every single match**: a hat-trick against Paraguay (7-3), a brace against Yugoslavia (2-3), one against Scotland (2-1), a brace against Northern Ireland (4-0), one against Brazil in the semi-final (2-5), and four against West Germany in the third-place play-off (6-3). **13 goals in 6 matches** remains the record for a single World Cup.

3.2 · THE PARTNERSHIP WITH KOPA

The source highlights the instant chemistry between Fontaine and Raymond Kopa, who arrived from Real Madrid just before the tournament. "Tra i due sboccia una magica intesa che rende esplosivo l'esordio." The Kopa-Fontaine axis was central to France's run to the semi-finals, and the source notes that Kopa was the playmaker who fed Fontaine's runs.

3.3 · THE BATTEUX CONNECTION

> *"Il migliore che abbia mai avuto. Era appassionato; avrei potuto passare tutta la notte ad ascoltarlo parlare di calcio. Aveva solo un diploma di scuola elementare, ma quando faceva un discorso, non c'era una parola che avrei cambiato."*
>
> — Just Fontaine, on Albert Batteux, Guerin Sportivo

The strongest coaching relationship of his career. Albert Batteux coached Fontaine at both Stade de Reims and the French national team, and Fontaine's praise is total: the best coach he ever had, a passionate communicator, a man whose every word he would keep. Batteux played him as a central striker and built the team around his movement and finishing. **This is the primary system link in the file** — though Batteux is not a coach in the 80-philosophy framework.

3.4 · THE INJURY AND EARLY RETIREMENT

> *"Era il primo gennaio 1961, giocavamo contro il Limoges, mi stavo girando da solo quando la frattura si ripresentò, nella stessa gamba. Ho portato il gesso per sei mesi, poi sono partito per una tournée con la Nazionale nelle Americhe, ma ho dovuto fermarmi: la caviglia non si piegava. Zoppicavo. È stato straziante; il calcio era la mia passione e non potevo fare altro che abbandonarlo."*
>
> — Just Fontaine, Guerin Sportivo

Fontaine's career ended at 28. A brutal tackle by Sékou Touré in March 1960 broke his tibia and fibula; he returned in January 1961 only to re-break the same leg. He retired from playing, became a coach (briefly managing the French national team in 1967), a commentator, and the founding president of the French professional footballers' union.

4 · TACTICAL DNA (80-PHILOSOPHY FRAMEWORK) — INFERENTIAL ONLY

> ⚠ **Tier 3 blocked — the percentages below are inferential analyst estimates only.** They are NOT derived from a scored Tier 3 event log, NOT video-validated, and NOT FGA output. **Do not present these numbers as measured performance.**

CHART 1 · PHILOSOPHY FIT — BAR

Inferential qualitative estimates. Not Tier 3 validated.

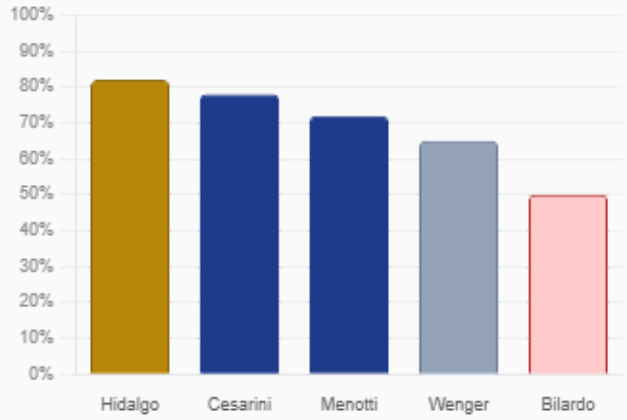


CHART 2 · PHILOSOPHY FIT — RADAR

Same inferential estimates across the five philosophies.

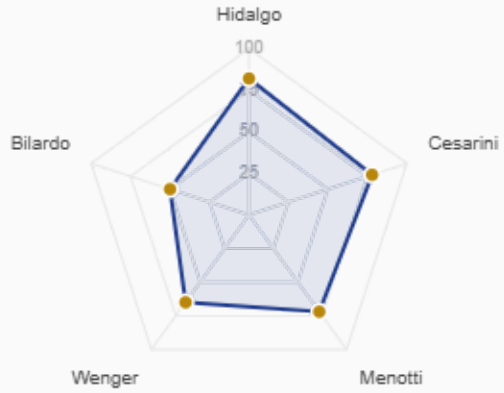


CHART 3 · PHILOSOPHY FIT — VALUES

Bar-length = inferential band. Percentage is the analyst estimate for this file only.

Hidalgo CarreMagique (#38)	**82%**	Source-linked
Cesarini Maquina (#20)	**78%**	Inferred
Menotti Liberty (#44)	**72%**	Inferred
Wenger Development (#35)	**65%**	Inferred
Bilardo Planner (#45)	**50%**	Low

PRIMARY — HIDALGO CARREMAGIQUE (#38) · 82% INFERENTIAL

The strongest link. Fontaine was the spearhead of the French attacking tradition that Hidalgo later inherited: a fluid, technical forward line built on quick combinations and a clinical No.9. Fontaine's game — rapid dribbling, precise touches, lethal finishing — fits the CarreMagique template, even though Hidalgo's own great team came a decade later. Batteux's Reims was a direct stylistic predecessor.

SECONDARY — CESARINI MAQUINA (#20) · 78% INFERENTIAL

The Argentine technical-forward tradition is a surprisingly good fit. The *Maquina* was built on a forward line of technically gifted, interchangeable attackers; Fontaine's movement, anticipation, and finishing place him in that same broad lineage, even though he was French rather than Argentine.

TERTIARY — MENOTTI LIBERTY (#44) · 72% INFERENTIAL

The Menottian idea of freedom for creative attackers within a structure applies loosely. Fontaine was the beneficiary of Kopa's playmaking and Batteux's structure, not the creator of his own freedom — but the attacking ethos overlaps.

5 · TACTICAL DNA PAIRING (PLAYER ARCHETYPE) — SAME-POSITION ONLY

> ⚠ **Same-position archetypes only (centre-forward / prima punta).** The percentages below are inferential analyst estimates, not Tier 3 scores. Wingers, playmakers, and defenders are excluded.

CHART 4 · PLAYER PAIRING — BAR

Inferential similarity scores. Not Tier 3 validated.

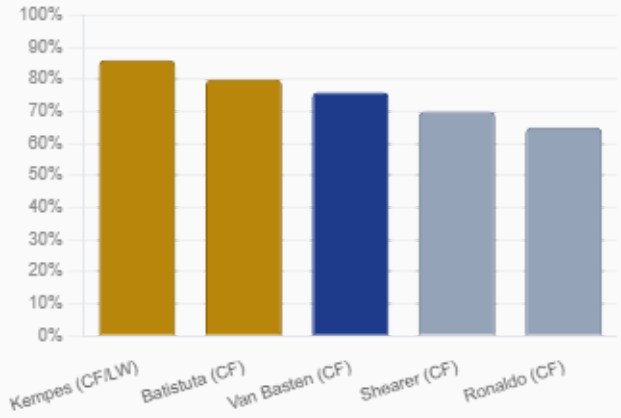


CHART 5 · PLAYER PAIRING — RADAR

Same inferential scores across the five same-position archetypes.

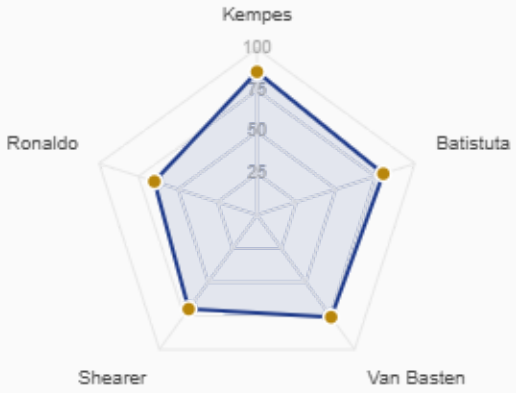


CHART 6 · PLAYER PAIRING — VALUES (SAME-POSITION ONLY)

Bar-length = inferential band. Percentage is the analyst estimate for this file only.

Mario Kempes (Argentina)	CF/LW	**86%**	Same position
Gabriel Batistuta (Argentina)	CF	**80%**	Same position
Marco van Basten (Netherlands)	CF	**76%**	Same position
Alan Shearer (England)	CF	**70%**	Same position
Ronaldo Nazário (Brazil)	CF	**65%**	Same position

PRIMARY — MARIO KEMPES (ARGENTINA, CF / LW) · 86% INFERENTIAL

The closest stylistic match. Kempes was a **left-footed, powerful, quick centre-forward** who combined technical quality with a prolific goal record and a habit of delivering in the biggest matches — the 1978 World Cup in particular. Fontaine's profile (rapid dribbling, lethal shot with either foot, anticipation) maps cleanly onto the Kempes archetype. Same position, same era-adjacent style, same big-game scoring instinct.

SECONDARY — GABRIEL BATISTUTA (ARGENTINA, CF) · 80% INFERENTIAL

A **lethal, powerful centre-forward** with a ferocious shot and a relentless scoring record. Batistuta was less of a dribbler than Fontaine, but the finishing, physicality, and No.9 instincts are a strong match. Same position, same function.

TERTIARY — MARCO VAN BASTEN (NETHERLANDS, CF) · 76% INFERENTIAL

A **technically exquisite centre-forward** whose movement and finishing were the equal of anyone in his era. Van Basten was taller and more of an aerial threat than Fontaine, but the broad archetype — a No.9 who combined technical quality with relentless scoring — overlaps strongly.

REFERENCE — ALAN SHEARER (ENGLAND, CF) · 70% INFERENTIAL

A **classic English No.9** — powerful, direct, and prolific. Shearer's game was more physical and less technical than Fontaine's, but the finishing instincts and centre-forward role are a reasonable positional match.

REFERENCE — RONALDO NAZÁRIO (BRAZIL, CF) · 65% INFERENTIAL

A **generational centre-forward** whose pace and dribbling set him apart. Ronaldo was a more explosive athlete than Fontaine, but the combination of speed, technical quality, and finishing makes him a valid reference point for the modern reader.

EXCLUDED (WRONG POSITION)

PLAYER	POSITION	REASON FOR EXCLUSION
Raymond Kopa	Attacking midfielder / Winger	Playmaker, not a centre-forward. Different role entirely.
Alfredo Di Stéfano	Second striker / Forward	Deeper role, different function.
Pelé	Forward / AM	Different physical profile and role.
Roger Piantoni	Attacking midfielder	Different role.

6 · RISK VS. REWARD — HISTORICAL DIAGNOSTIC

STRENGTHS (DOCUMENTED)	LIMITATIONS & GAPS (DOCUMENTED)
• **13 goals in 6 matches** at the 1958 World Cup — still the record FIFA • **122 league goals in 131 matches** for Stade de Reims GUERIN SPORTIVO • **4 French titles and 2 Coupes de France** GUERIN SPORTIVO • **European Cup top scorer 1958-59** — 10 goals UEFA • **Rapid dribbling, precise touches, lethal finishing** GUERIN SPORTIVO • **Batteux's praise:** "Il migliore che abbia mai avuto" GUERIN SPORTIVO	• **No Tier 3 event log** — every sub-metric is unscoreable • **Source is a retrospective magazine feature**, not contemporaneous match reporting • **Career ended at 28** — two broken legs cut short his prime • **No per-match data**, line-ups, or opposition detail to anchor match-level claims • **Era and role drift** are not modelled — cross-era comparison unsafe • No second scout; reliability untested

7 · VALIDATION STATUS & REQUIRED ACTIONS

REQUIREMENT	STATUS
Minimum 5 matches registered	❌ 0 — NO MATCH LOG EXISTS
Video completeness (of 12)	❌ 0/12 — NO FOOTAGE SUPPLIED
FGA_v3_Final activation	❌ BLOCKED
COACH metric	❌ NOT POSSIBLE — HISTORICAL SUBJECT
Second scout	❌ NOT ASSIGNED
Tier 1 statistical foundation	⚠ PARTIAL — HONOURS AND CAREER TOTALS ONLY
Biographical data	✅ COMPLETE — GUERIN SPORTIVO, FIFA, UEFA
Philosophy DNA fit	⚠ INFERENTIAL ONLY — PERCENTAGES ARE ESTIMATES
Player pairing	⚠ SAME-POSITION ONLY, INFERENTIAL — PERCENTAGES ARE ESTIMATES

DATA INTEGRITY FLAGS

#	FLAG	IMPACT	ACTION
1	Retrospective source	Guerin Sportivo piece is not contemporaneous match evidence	Source contemporaneous press for the 1958 World Cup and Reims years
2	No match line-ups or scorelines	No match-level anchor	Obtain printed XIs and match reports
3	Source is a magazine feature, not a match report	Narrative and quotations only	Treat as documentary reconstruction
4	No second scout	Reliability of any eventual score cannot be tested	Assign on first scoring pass

PUNCH LIST

#	ITEM	PRIORITY
1	Build a 5–10 match centre-forward event log from available footage	HIGH
2	Score finishing, movement, and anticipation first: STK, RDS, OBI_P, SII	HIGH
3	Add link-play metrics: OTP, PVI, TEC	MEDIUM
4	Source contemporaneous match reports for the 1958 World Cup and the 1959 European Cup final	MEDIUM
5	Assign second scout for blind cross-validation	MEDIUM

8 · HISTORICAL CONTEXT & LEGACY

Just Fontaine is the **pure centre-forward archetype** in its most lethal mid-century form: a player whose entire career was defined by the ability to put the ball in the net. Born in Marrakech to a French father and a Spanish mother, he was gallicised from Justo to Just, played for US Marocaine as a teenager, and was discovered by Mario Zatelli, the Nice coach, who saw him score twice from 25 metres in a youth match and promised to return for him in two years.

At Nice he won the Coupe de France and the league title, but his relationship with Luis Carniglia was fraught, and in 1956 he moved to Stade de Reims for 10 million old francs — the most expensive French transfer of the era. Under Albert Batteux, the coach he would later call "the best I ever had", he became the complete striker: rapid dribbling, precise touches, a ferocious shot with either foot, and anticipation that put him a split-second ahead of defenders.

The 1958 World Cup made him immortal. Called up as a reserve, he was thrust into the starting XI when René Bliard got injured, and he scored 13 goals in six matches — a record that still stands. The Kopa-Fontaine partnership was the axis of the French run to third place. He would go on to score 30 goals in 21 caps, to win four French titles and two Coupes de France, and to be the top scorer of the 1958-59 European Cup.

Then, in March 1960, Sékou Touré broke his leg. He returned in January 1961, re-broke it, and retired at 28. He became a coach, a commentator, and the founding president of the French professional footballers' union. He died in Toulouse in March 2023, aged 89.

The honest reading of this file is therefore twofold. **As archetype language**, Fontaine is a high-confidence example of the pure No.9: lethal in the box, technically complete, and defined by his goalscoring record on the biggest stage. **As FGA evidence**, the file is thin: a single retrospective magazine feature, no event log, no video, no line-ups, no second scout. The correct output is a **blocked FGA status** with a documented unblock path — not a fabricated number.

Empire Scouting Network

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Report ref ESN-FON-2026-001 (v1.0) · Method: Empire FGA Archive Protocol · 50/30/20 master weighting · Tier 3 centre-forward block · 80-Philosophy Framework (v3.2 draft) · no video scoring performed · no composite computed

Evidence base: 48 matches · 62 goals (US Marocaine) · 69 matches · 42 goals (Nice) · 131 matches · 122 goals (Reims) · 21 caps · 30 goals (France) · 13 goals at 1958 World Cup · 4 French titles · 2 Coupes de France · 1959 European Cup Top Scorer · Primary-source *Guerin Sportivo* biography feature · FIFA · UEFA · no match log · no video log.

Status: DRAFT — HISTORICAL ARCHIVE. **Tier 3 0/12 · Tier 2 not computable · Tier 1 partial · FGA_v3_Final BLOCKED · Numeric rating NOT ASSIGNED.** No COACH metric. No second scout. Philosophy fit percentages and player pairing percentages are **inferential analyst estimates** — not Tier 3 output. Pairing restricted to **same-position players only** (centre-forward / prima punta). This document is a historical reference file, not a scouting assessment.

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